

CUSTOMER SUCCESS RESOURCE LIBRARY · REFERENCE GUIDE

Customer Success Acronyms Reference

The Shorthand Every CSM Hears in Their First Month

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Customer Success Acronyms Reference

Customer Success professionals work across multiple departments, making acronyms a regular part of meetings, documentation, executive reports, and customer conversations.

This appendix provides a quick-reference directory of the most commonly used abbreviations across Customer Success, SaaS, Product, Sales, Revenue Operations, Support, and Artificial Intelligence.

Customer Success

Acronym Meaning

- CS Customer Success
 - CSM Customer Success Manager
 - CS Ops Customer Success Operations
 - CSP Customer Success Plan
 - CHS Customer Health Score
 - CX Customer Experience
 - VoC Voice of the Customer
 - VOC Program Voice of Customer Program
 - EBR Executive Business Review
 - QBR Quarterly Business Review
 - BR Business Review
 - CJR Customer Journey Review
 - SLA Service Level Agreement
 - SOP Standard Operating Procedure
 - RCA Root Cause Analysis
 - KPI Key Performance Indicator
 - OKR Objectives and Key Results
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Customer Metrics

Acronym Meaning

- ARR Annual Recurring Revenue
 - MRR Monthly Recurring Revenue
 - ACV Annual Contract Value
 - TCV Total Contract Value
 - CLV Customer Lifetime Value
 - LTV Lifetime Value
 - CAC Customer Acquisition Cost
 - NRR Net Revenue Retention
 - GRR Gross Revenue Retention
 - CRR Customer Retention Rate
 - CES Customer Effort Score
 - CSAT Customer Satisfaction
 - NPS Net Promoter Score
 - TTV Time to Value
 - TTFV Time to First Value
 - FCR First Contact Resolution
 - FRT First Response Time
 - ART Average Resolution Time
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Product Metrics

Acronym Meaning

- DAU Daily Active Users
- WAU Weekly Active Users

MAU Monthly Active Users
DAU/MAU Stickiness Ratio
PQL Product Qualified Lead
SQL Sales Qualified Lead
MQL Marketing Qualified Lead
API Application Programming Interface
UI User Interface
UX User Experience

Revenue & Business

Acronym Meaning

SaaS Software as a Service
TAM Total Addressable Market
SAM Serviceable Available Market
SOM Serviceable Obtainable Market
GTM Go-to-Market Strategy
PLG Product-Led Growth
SLG Sales-Led Growth
ROI Return on Investment
ROAS Return on Advertising Spend
EBITDA Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation and Amortization
CAGR Compound Annual Growth Rate
GM Gross Margin

Customer Support

Acronym Meaning

SLA Service Level Agreement

SLA Breach Failure to meet agreed service standards

L1 Level One Support

L2 Level Two Support

L3 Level Three Support

KB Knowledge Base

FAQ Frequently Asked Questions

Artificial Intelligence

Acronym Meaning

AI Artificial Intelligence

ML Machine Learning

NLP Natural Language Processing

LLM Large Language Model

RAG Retrieval-Augmented Generation

HITL Human-in-the-Loop

OCR Optical Character Recognition

STT Speech-to-Text

TTS Text-to-Speech

BI Business Intelligence

Revenue Operations

Acronym Meaning

CRM Customer Relationship Management

RevOps Revenue Operations
SalesOps Sales Operations
FinOps Financial Operations
DevOps Development Operations
ERP Enterprise Resource Planning
BI Business Intelligence
ETL Extract, Transform, Load

Project Management

Acronym Meaning

PM Project Management
PMO Project Management Office
PRD Product Requirements Document
MVP Minimum Viable Product
RACI Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed
RAID Risks, Assumptions, Issues, Dependencies
WBS Work Breakdown Structure
UAT User Acceptance Testing

Executive & Leadership

Acronym Meaning

CEO Chief Executive Officer
COO Chief Operating Officer
CFO Chief Financial Officer
CRO Chief Revenue Officer

CPO Chief Product Officer

CTO Chief Technology Officer

CIO Chief Information Officer

CMO Chief Marketing Officer

VP Vice President

IC Individual Contributor

Why This Appendix Matters

Mastering these acronyms helps Customer Success professionals communicate confidently with executives, collaborate effectively across departments, understand strategic discussions, and interpret dashboards, reports, and business documents without ambiguity.

As organizations grow, fluency in this shared language becomes an important professional advantage and enables Customer Success teams to participate more effectively in cross-functional decision-making.

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About the Author

David Maika is a Customer Success professional with experience spanning customer operations, process improvement, CRM implementation, project management, and business strategy. His work focuses on helping organizations improve customer outcomes, strengthen operational efficiency, and build scalable systems that support long-term growth.

Through practical frameworks, real-world case studies, and modern AI-assisted workflows, he aims to make Customer Success knowledge accessible, actionable, and valuable for professionals at every stage of their careers.

To learn more, access additional resources, or connect professionally, visit davidmaika.com or linkedin.com/in/davidmaika.

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